

Ngo, Teo & Byrne: Modelling Interface Aesthetics

Verified reference summary • Year: 2003 • Source bibliography: docs/REFERENCES.md

What the paper contributes

Ngo, Teo, and Byrne provide a classic set of closed-form interface-aesthetics measures. Their measures include balance, equilibrium, symmetry, sequence, cohesion, unity, proportion, simplicity, density, regularity, economy, homogeneity, rhythm, and order/complexity.

Method / evaluation stance

The key value for slidekit is that many subjective-looking design qualities can be computed from element bounding boxes. This gives a defensible basis for measuring balance, density, regularity, and order without rendering an image.

How slidekit uses it

slidekit uses this lineage in its geometry-first aesthetic score. A slide is not judged by a model staring at pixels; it is judged by the positions, sizes, roles, and colors that the layout engine already knows. That keeps checks fast and repeatable.

YAML vs HTML takeaway

The limitation is that bounding-box measures do not see photographic texture, visual salience, or fine typographic rasterization. HTML/screenshots can expose those qualities, but at the cost of a heavier and less deterministic pipeline.

Bottom line

The paper supports a pragmatic split: use research-style rendered artifacts when the question depends on final pixels or human preference collection, but keep slidekit production decks in a constrained YAML IR so layout, linting, and agent fixes remain deterministic, inspectable, and cheap.

Primary slidekit mapping	balance / alignment / whitespace / overlap / contrast / richness / consistency, depending on the paper
Operational risk	HTML metrics can drift with rendering environment; YAML metrics can miss pixel-only effects. Use each where it is strongest.